



Main man: In Norway's qualifying campaign, Erling Haaland (centre) netted 16 of the team's 37 goals. AFP

players in the 26-man squad who were not even born the last time the nation played at the World Cup in 1998.

After having to watch the recent World Cup and European Championship on TV screens, Norway blazed through the qualifying tournament, scoring 37 goals and conceding just five, while also beating former champion Italy home and away.

Just like France, the Norwegians are heavily reliant on their experienced stars like Haaland, Martin Odegaard, and Alexander Sorloth, to name a few. But if the journey to North America is a sign of things to come, it would be unwise to rule out the possibility of Stale Solbakken's side going deep into the competition.

Meanwhile, the last of the big trio in the group, Senegal, arrives at the tournament with a lot of eyes on it owing to the AFCON final fiasco earlier this year.

While Senegal won 1-0 on the night against host Morocco, a decision to walk off the pitch in protest and later return was viewed as forfeiting the game by the Confederation of African Football, which declared Morocco champion.

The Lions of Teranga have chosen to completely ignore CAF's decision and will compete with the belief that they are the best

ON THE RADAR



Kylian Mbappe (France)

With two finals reached in two appearances, Kylian Mbappe has already established himself as a World Cup great. And despite a brilliant scoring record (42 goals this season), a second consecutive trophyless campaign with Real Madrid will leave the 27-year-old raring to get his hands on silverware.



Erling Haaland (Norway)

High-profile departures and missing out on the league title late might have overshadowed Erling Haaland's season. But the Norwegian was in fine form again, grabbing his third Premier League Golden Boot (27 goals) in four years at the club. Moreover, playing in his first major international tournament, he will be eager to extend his lead as Norway's all-time top scorer.